Nickita Khylkouski

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Experience

Peak Security Jul 2026 – Present
Founder *San Francisco, CA*

- Pentest websites cheaply and at scale, then report the vulnerabilities. $0 to six-figure MRR in four months; $350K profit to date.
- Ran about 19,000 assessments at $1.50 each on average, 1.5T tokens in total, at a profit. Built the system that runs hundreds at once across hundreds of VMs at roughly 200M tokens per minute without losing or corrupting runs.
- Found and reported security issues involving a16z, Palantir, Thiel Fellows, Y Combinator, Broadcom, JPMorgan Chase, federal banks, and local governments. Findings paid up to $30K and uncovered active intrusions by third parties that were referred to the FBI.
- YC Fellows ($20K grant) and Palantir Valley Forge ($10K grant).

Replit Jun 2026 – Aug 2026
Security Engineer & SWE Intern *San Francisco, CA*

- Built and led the launch of Black-box Pen Tests: attacks deployed apps from the outside, no source access, and reports only confirmed vulnerabilities.
- Shipped as a built-in scan in Replit's Security Center. Launch reached about 150K views.

Cerebral Valley Dec 2025 – Jun 2026
Security Engineer / Software Engineer *San Francisco, CA*

- Built the applicant sorting system for Anthropic's Opus 4.7 / 4.8 events: 40,000 applicants reduced to 1,000 by pairwise LLM comparisons and Elo-style rating.
- Ran OSINT on 6K+ applicants: thousands of research agents enriched every profile for recruiting and sponsor analytics.
- Hired after responsibly disclosing vulnerabilities in the company's platform.

AI Valley Oct 2025 – Feb 2026
Tech Lead *San Francisco, CA*

- Built judging and submission software used by 5K+ hackathon users: scoring, submissions, reviewer workflows, live event ops.
- Helped host 19 AI events with OpenAI, Google, Anthropic, Netflix, AWS, Vercel, and Y Combinator: 3,700+ attendees, including one 1,200+ signup event. Spoke at TechEx North America on building AI coding agents.

Projects

Multicore Server Challenge | *x86-64 assembly, epoll, Postgres* 2026

- Web server in x86-64 assembly: 130,000 users at p99 under 1 s on 8 vCPUs. #2 of 84 on the leaderboard.

PolyTrack TAS | *JavaScript, search and optimization* 2026

- Patched 2 bytes of the physics engine to run it 2x faster. Beat the world record on all 17 tracks by 13–130 ms.

Minecraft YouTube Map | *Python, embeddings, WebGL* 2026

- Mapped 487K Minecraft YouTube videos from 523 channels three ways: title, description, and thumbnail.

Drug Review Embeddings | *Python, text embeddings* 2026

- Embedded 501K drug reviews. 18% of surprise benefits reviewers flagged were later studied, vs 6.7% on other drugs.

Open Source | *Python, Java, Go, TypeScript* 2024 – Present

- 20+ PRs to open source, including Google's Mug, Dotprompt, Guava, and go-github, and other repos.

Awards & Teaching

2nd place, $10K: YC Hack the Stackathon, after predicting the 1st and 3rd place teams before judging.
Audience Favorite: Alif × Replit World's Greatest Tournament, for finding vulnerabilities in oil ships in Venezuela and Nigeria and reporting them.
Winner: AGI House AI4Healthcare, cua.ai Computer-Use Agents Hackathon, Replicate Hackathon, Dumb Hackathon, Single Shot Hackathon, AGI House × Omi, Hack for Social Impact.
Inspirit AI: taught AI fundamentals to 60 students.

Skills

Python, TypeScript, Go, Java, C/C++, x86-64 assembly · web/API pentesting, OSINT, LLM agents